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Improve Your First Impression: The Serendipity Experiment

Understand how the world sees you, and grow through feedback. Finally, get a second chance to make a first impression. iOS & Android



Serendipity Team

First created • 2 backed

More

\$240



pledged of \$17,653 goal

5

backers

 Software

 Toronto, Canada

Funding Unsuccessful

The project's funding goal was not reached on Sat, August 23 2014 12:00 AM UTC +06:00

 **Last updated** [August 23, 2014](#)[Campaign](#)[Rewards](#)[Creator](#)[FAQ](#)[Updates](#) ⁰[Comments](#) ¹

Story

SERENDIPITY: THE TRUEST MIRROR YOU WILL EVER HAVE.

How do people perceive you? Intelligent? Good looking? Arrogant? Someone who stands out from the crowd? How do you know? What if you could find out, with certainty, how you came across? And what if you had a proven method of tuning your image to present yourself in an ideal way? What would that be worth to you? **This is what Serendipity offers: Certainty in knowing how others perceive you, and the means to optimize that perception.**

Funding period

Jul 24 2014 - Aug 23 2014 (30 days)



To give you that knowledge, Serendipity combines three scientifically documented phenomena: **the strength of first impressions, perceived**

value, and the wisdom of the crowd.

On joining Serendipity, you begin having four-minute text-chat conversations with other members, who are adults of any age from practically everywhere on Earth. After each conversation, you and your new acquaintance rank each other on multiple instances of three categories of personal identifiers: appearance, individuality, and character.

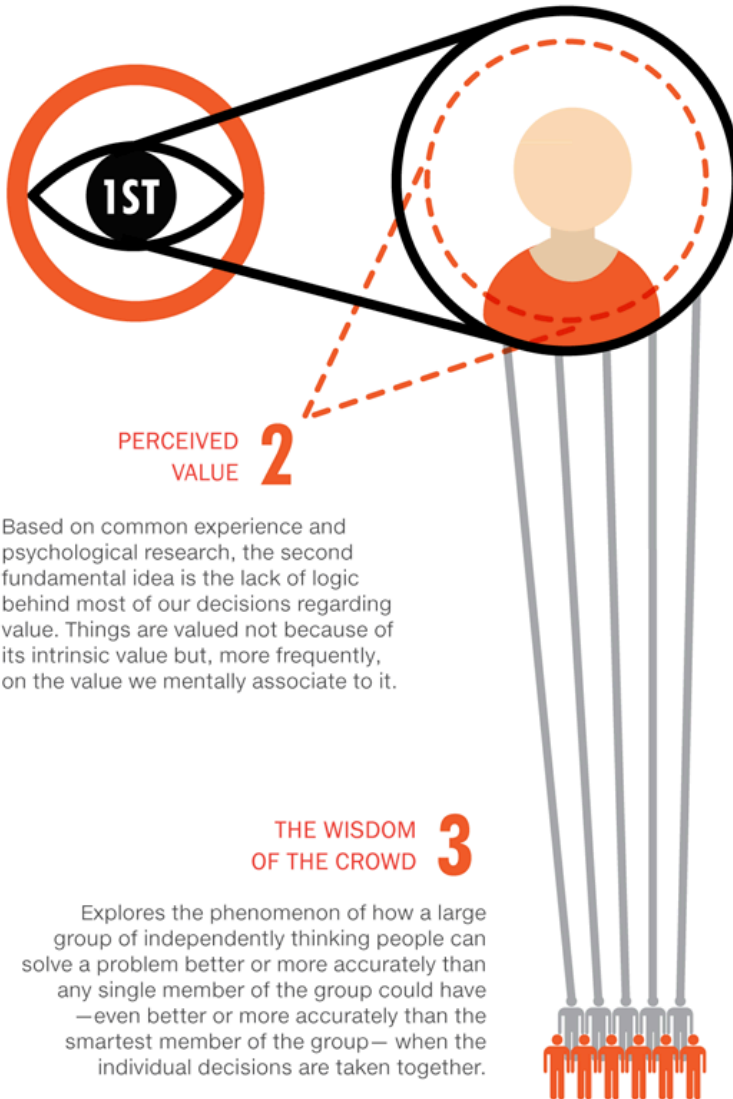
As you have more conversations, a profile emerges of how others perceive you; the more Serendipity conversations you have, the clearer your profile becomes. You can rely on Serendipity being a true mirror of your image because of its foundation in scientific reality.

THE SCIENCE BEHIND SERENDIPITY

SYNERGY IN THE
COMBINATION OF OUR
MAIN THREE IDEAS

THE STRENGTH OF FIRST IMPRESSIONS 1

The first big idea behind Serendipity is very intuitive, and backed by decades of scientific research: first impressions are incredibly strong. We also form them incredibly fast (in less than one second).

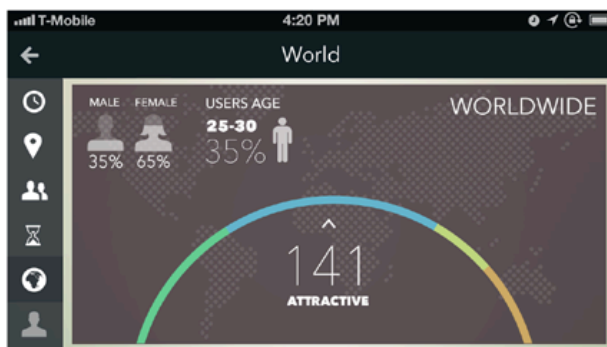
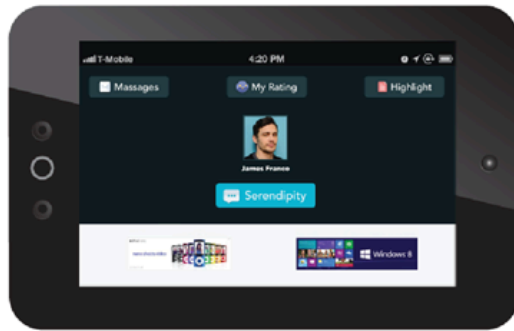


PRIVACY

Given that the Serendipity app accumulates and compiles detailed information about how others perceive you, you may wonder how safe the data concerning you is with us. The answer: perfectly safe. Each Serendipity user is absolutely anonymous to all other Serendipity users. You will identify any other user only through a pseudonym, which is how any other user will identify you. Aside from your registration information, you are even anonymous to the Serendipity app itself!

HOW WE DEVELOPED SERENDIPITY

For a long time we've been interested in how the strength of first impressions combines with the concept of perceived value—read books about these ideas, and followed and contributed to blogs. But when we read James Surowiecki's *The Wisdom of the Crowds: Why the Many Are Smarter Than the Few and How Collective Wisdom Shapes Business, Economies, Societies and Nations*, the light bulb really lit up. As social-media programmers, we saw how we could connect all three of these ideas, and help people connect with each other in a more positive way. We saw how social media could overcome the errors inherent in first impressions and perceived value. We designed Serendipity for scalability, including the eventual integration with mobile and other applications.

A screenshot of the 'Rate This Person' screen. It features a text input field with the placeholder 'Write message...' and a 'Send' button. A virtual keyboard is visible at the bottom of the screen.

FUNDING GOALS



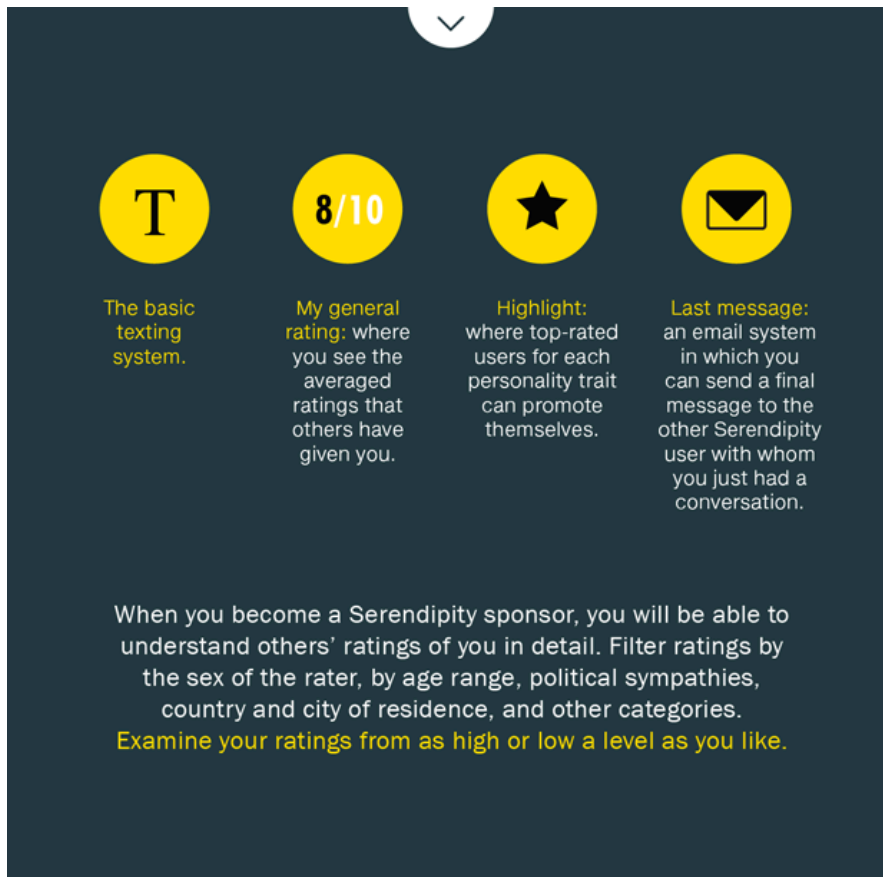
TO REACH THOSE GOALS, SERENDIPITY
OFFERS TWO TIERS OF MEMBERSHIP:

A FREE TIER THAT PROVIDES ALL OF
SERENDIPITY'S CORE FUNCTIONALITY,

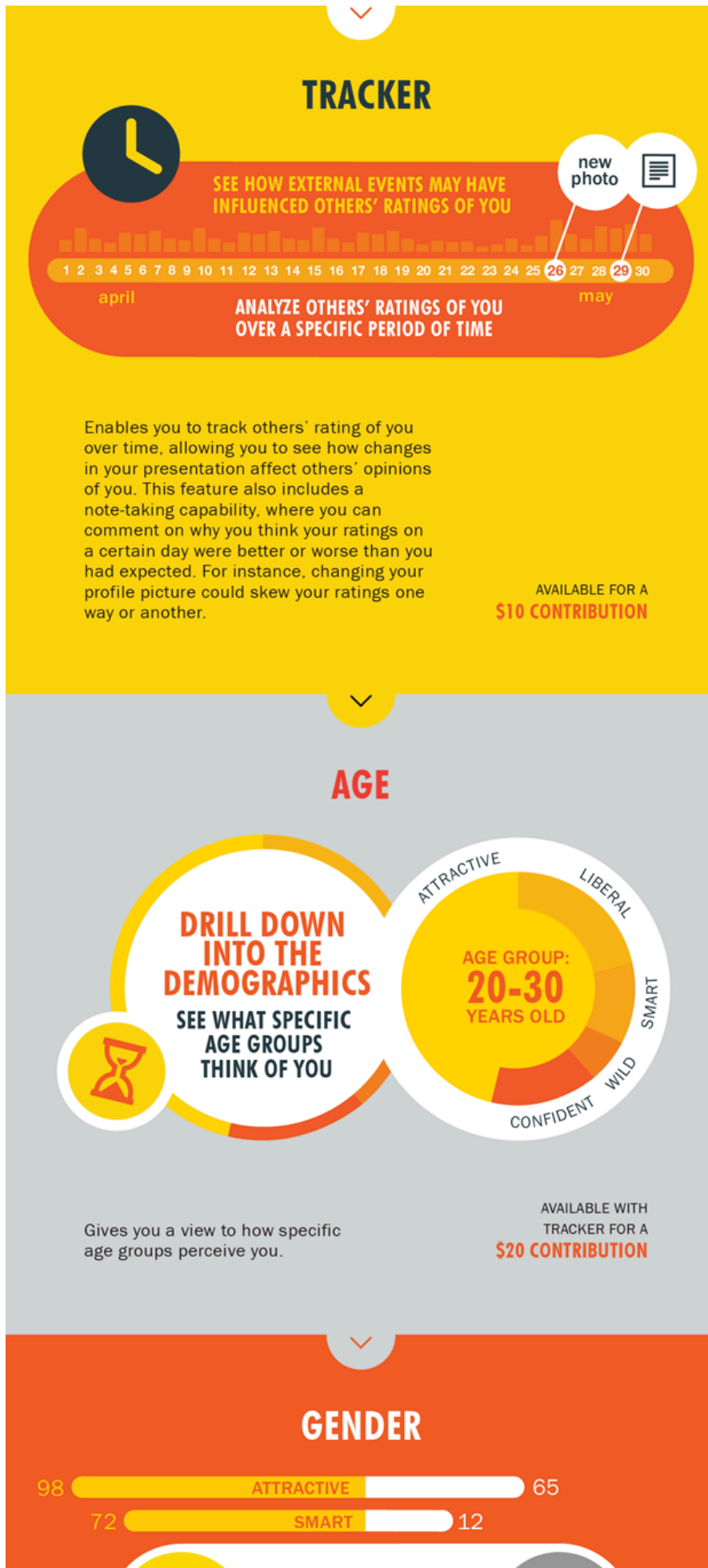
— AND —

A SPONSORS' TIER THAT PROVIDES
EXTENDED FUNCTIONALITY.

THE CORE FUNCTIONALITY AVAILABLE IN THE FREE TIER INCLUDES:



THE EXTENDED FUNCTIONALITY AVAILABLE IN THE SPONSORS' TIER INCLUDES:

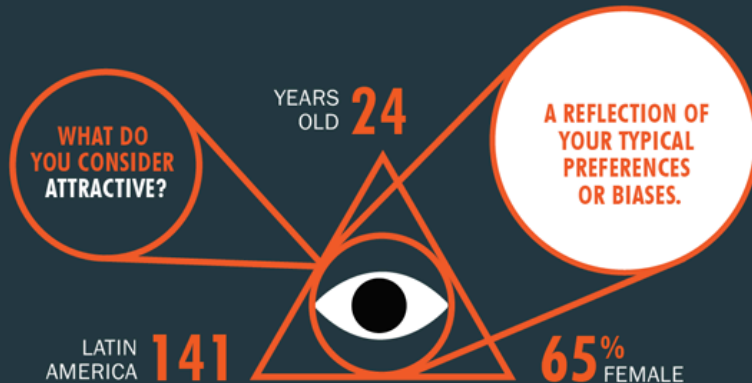




other Serendipity users rank specific demographics, like 23-year-old males from Madison, Wisconsin. Find out which U.S. city ranks first in intelligence, attractiveness, or any other parameter, in the eyes of other Serendipity members. Also allows you to turn the telescope around and reveal how, say, 45-year-old males living in New York rank individuals of your demographic.

AVAILABLE WITH
TRACKER, AGE, GENDER
AND WORLD FOR A
\$50 CONTRIBUTION

IN MY EYES

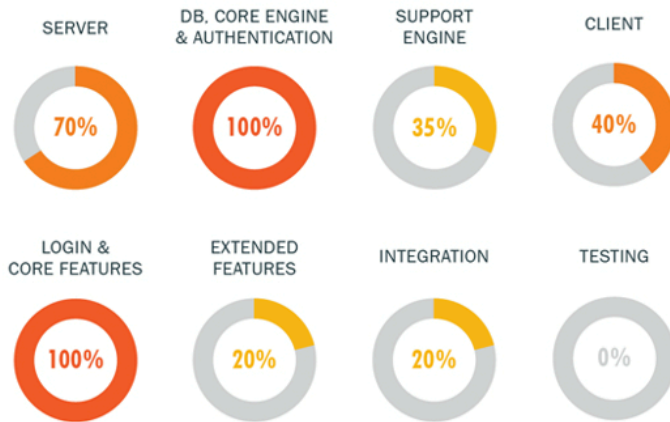


This feature aggregates your evaluations of other Serendipity users by demographic. Do you tend to rank other members higher simply because they are males between the ages of 30 and 45 living in California? Maybe you didn't realize how attractive or intelligent you thought women from New York are. In My Eyes reflects your preferences and proclivities back to you, helping you to understand yourself and others better.

AVAILABLE WITH TRACKER,
AGE, GENDER, WORLD,
AND BIG PICTURE FOR A
\$60 CONTRIBUTION

KICKSTARTER EXCLUSIVE: BACKERS WILL HAVE LIFE TIME ACCESS TO THEIR BACKED FEATURES.

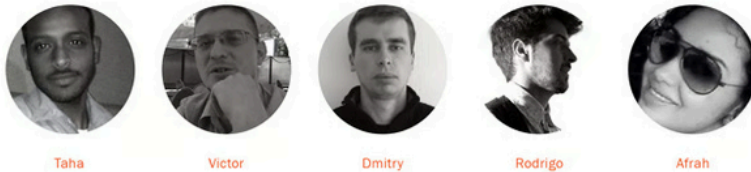
STATUS OF DEVELOPMENT



iOS RELEASE IS EXPECTED BY LATE SEPTEMBER

Special Note to Sponsors: The six extended features described above will be available to you, exclusively, at launch. Noncontributing members will not have access to those features at the launch, Once it is available for them, it will be at a higher price . So if you begin your sponsorship sooner, not only will you sooner gain the knowledge we all want, but you will also get a better deal for it!

SERENDIPITY TEAM



The Founder of Serendipity, Taha, is an IT analyst in a Fortune 500 company, with an extensive background in PMP. Taha and the rest of the team — Victor, Dmitry, Rodrigo and Afrah — admittedly we're not household names. But then again, 15 years ago who ever heard of Larry Page and Sergey Brin? And ten years ago, Mark Zuckerberg was just another guy you'd see hanging out in Harvard Square. What we have going for us is that we're all hardcore geeks who are determined to make this venture succeed.

Risks and challenges

As a start-up, the fundamental risk we pose to you is that not enough people will participate in Serendipity to make the crowd wise enough. But we think this idea is cool, and that our wise crowd will gather soon enough.

On the technical side our core engine is made to scale, use minimum resources and be a platform neutral. Some of the features are not similar "technical terms" to anything out there that we know of, this makes it pretty difficult task yet we are capable technically and 200% committed.

[Learn about accountability on Kickstarter](#)

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Justin Kolbeck

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Lindsay



 10 days left • 81% funded



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KICKSTARTER

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